

IT History Timeline

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Mechanical Computer Era 1820's

Information technology stores, processes, and retrieve information on computers. Charles Babbler was the first person to create the mechanical computer. This will be a cycle that will eventually grow and lead to what we use in our daily lives. The mechanical computers existence is vital because it will be used for things like the Electronic Numerical Integrator and Computer (ENIAC).



ENIAC Era 1946

At the University of Pennsylvania a team worked together to make the first programmable computer called ENIAC. It did not include keyboards or monitors but punch cards. Everything was handwritten, it can read input data, proved to be important because it created firing tables for the military. Helping the gun operator's hit the correct target. Weighing 30 tons and 1,800 square feet the ENIAC became solely military use.



Photo Cited from [Fundamentals of Information Technology.](#)

OS Systems Era 1960's-1970's

The ENIAC eventually progressed into computer programming called Operating Systems (OS). OS is like the brain to the body. It controls all parts of the computer. Around 1971, Ken Thompson built Unix software (Un-multiplexed Information and Computing Service) to support his hobby in gameplay. Unix eventually became pivotal as AT&T funded the development and eventually released to multiple organizations.



Personal Computer Era 1980's

Ultimately computers became expensive for personal use. IBM capitalized on the chance to create small, self-contained personal computers. Unix was made for giant computers. Until IBM worked with Microsoft to create Disk Operating Systems (DOS) that would be used for personal computers (PC). It did make it easier for use, as commands needed to be typed, not handwritten. Important because this will kick off the PC revolution.





Internet and World Wide Web Era 1980's-1990's

As PC progressed so did the means of communication. Computer engineers quickly caught on for the need of information swapping. Networks were used in offices letting them send emails or share printers. This started the network effect. It was the key motivator within the network computer industry. This is crucial to the development of the Internet and World Wide Web as it will be used in schools, homes, or offices.



Smartphone Era 1990's-Present

Personal computers and network connections were used more in households, creating developments in storage, battery capacity, screens and materials. Becoming essential to what we use on the daily basis **SMARTPHONES!** Windows was the superior operating system. That is until Apple iOS and Google's Android, which traces back to Unix. Mobile phones become vital, it's like a tiny computer in your pocket. It holds information, can communicate even around the world, and holds all the apps we use today.





Resource Slide

- [Fundamentals of Information Technology](#)